ISE542

Knowledge Management

Week 8 – In-class Exercise / Suggested Solutions

Meta Level of Knowledge for Customer Service Management

Complete Transcript of Lecturer's Explanation
(Audio: ISE542_W08_Lecture1_Answer.m4a)

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Note: *This document combines the lecture slide content with a cleaned, structured full transcript of the lecturer's spoken explanation. Minor transcription corrections have been made for clarity while remaining faithful to the original meaning.*

1. Original Slide Content (Suggested Solutions)

The following is the exact suggested solution shown on the lecture slide:

In-class Exercise / (Suggested Solutions)
Discuss the meta level of knowledge for customer service management. Briefly explain how different levels of knowledge are articulated to each other.

- **Customer service at Level 0** relates to data and information given to the customers.
- **Level 1 knowledge** for customer service relates to advisory services provided by the customer service staff which is based on the customer data and information (Level 0).
- **Level 2 knowledge** for customer service relates to the expert knowledge of training consultant who trains up the customer service staff to manage knowledge at Level 1 and Level 0.

2. Full Cleaned Transcript of Lecturer's Explanation

The lecturer elaborates on the slide content and emphasises the hierarchical / reflective relationship between knowledge levels.

Opening / Context

When we talk about customer service management, different knowledge levels are related to one another. Level 0 is the foundation; higher levels are built upon and reflect on the lower levels.

Level 0 – Data & Information to Customers

For Level 0 (sometimes called Level C in the spoken explanation), customer survey / customer-related data and information already exist. This is the basic data and information that is given to or collected about the customers. It is the raw material of customer service – regardless of whether staff do anything further with it, the customer data is already there.

Level 1 – Advisory Services by Customer Service Staff

Level 1 is a model of customer service that advises staff how to use the information. The staff who serve the company / customers need Level 1 knowledge so they know how to look at the (Level 0) information and use it to serve the customer properly. In short, Level 1 knowledge = advisory services provided by customer service staff that are based on Level 0 data and information.

Level 2 – Expert Knowledge of Training Consultants (Meta Level)

Level 2 knowledge relates to expert knowledge used for training. Training consultants / people who train customer service staff need to use systems (for example KM systems) to recall customer survey management posts, harvest teaching materials, and then teach the staff. This Level 2 knowledge is built on both Level 1 and Level 0. After the staff have served customers, the case stories and case information they carry (which embody Level 1 and Level 0 knowledge) are collected. From these, a higher level of knowledge is created that is used to train the staff further. That is why, when you are a teaching consultant developing training for staff who serve customers, you handle knowledge from Level 1 and Level 0 together, and then provide reflection so that staff know whether they have served the customer well or not. If they have not served well, they need to improve.

How the Levels Articulate / Reflect on Each Other

The lower levels (Level 0 and Level 1), after staff have served the customer, feed into the higher level. The higher level (Level 2 / meta level) is a reflection of the lower levels. It is created so that the process of survey / customer service management can be improved. Meta-level knowledge is therefore built from lower levels upward, and each higher level reflects on and improves the lower ones.

Important warning from the lecturer: Do not invent unrealistically high levels (e.g. “Level 11”). Normally, if you can identify knowledge at Level 3 or Level 4, that is already a very high level, because those levels deal with improvement of concepts of improvement itself. Level 4 is already considered high.

What is NOT Acceptable as Different Levels

The lecturer cautions students against naïve solutions that simply label items as different levels when they are actually at the same level. Example given: saying “English language learning – the land time is Level 1, the world is Level 2, a sand time is Level 3” is not acceptable. These are not genuine meta-level relationships; one does not truly reflect on or improve the other in a hierarchical knowledge sense. Such solutions are naïve and not helpful. Students must think about the fundamental nature of the knowledge hierarchy – higher levels must genuinely reflect on and improve the lower levels.

Closing Remark

Meta-level knowledge is built from low to high, and each level builds upon / reflects the previous one. Keep the hierarchy clear, ensure higher levels are truly reflective of lower levels, and avoid artificial or non-reflective level distinctions.

3. Structured Summary of Knowledge Levels

Level	Description (from slide + lecturer)	Role / Relationship
Level 0	Data and information given to / about the customers (customer survey data, basic customer information).	Foundation layer. Raw material used by staff.
Level 1	Advisory services provided by customer service staff, based on Level 0 data and information. Staff know how to look at and use the information to serve customers.	Operational / application layer. Built on Level 0.

Level 2 (Meta)	Expert knowledge of training consultants who train the customer service staff. Uses KM systems, case stories, teaching materials harvested from Level 0 + Level 1 experience. Provides reflection so staff can improve.	Reflective / improvement layer. Built on and improves Level 0 + Level 1.

4. Key Takeaways from the Lecturer

- Higher knowledge levels must be genuinely built on, and reflective of, lower levels – not just arbitrarily numbered.
- Meta-level knowledge (here Level 2) enables improvement of the lower-level processes (staff performance, survey management).
- Avoid naïve solutions that label unrelated or same-level items as different hierarchical levels.
- In practice, reaching Level 3 or 4 (improvement of improvement concepts) is already considered high; do not invent extreme levels.
- When designing training or KM interventions, consultants work with the combination of Level 0 + Level 1 experience to create reflective Level 2 knowledge.

— End of complete transcript —

Source materials: ISE542_W08_Lecture1_Answer.m4a (audio) + in-class exercise slide (IMG_2746). Prepared for study purposes. Content follows the original lecturer's explanation.